

SPARK ART BRIEF

Drop-in specification for building SparkMyName client deliverables

Founder: Peter Klein · VORREX IGNITE LLC · Version 1.0 — July 24, 2026

***How to use this document.** Attach it at the start of any session that builds client deliverables and say: "Follow the Spark Art Brief." It is not carried in the site disc — it lives separately, loads only when needed, and governs that session.*

PART ONE — THE EIGHT RULES

These override any instinct, preference, or improvement Claude may be tempted toward.

1. USE WHAT IS DELIVERED, UNCHANGED.

The art department returns finished work through API calls: the logo suite (Primary, Icon, Wordmark), favicons, the color palette, taglines, copy, and photos. These are **placed, never processed**. No background removal. No re-tracing. No re-deriving. No re-sharpening. No re-coloring. If artwork looks wrong in a composition, the placement is wrong — never the artwork.

2. PALETTE FROM THE BRAND CARD. LOGO ON CLEAN NEUTRAL.

The colors on the brand card are the only colors. Never sample colors off a logo image. Never harmonize, substitute, or improve them. The logo suite and the palette come from two separate API calls and may not match each other — this is expected and is not a problem to solve. It is handled by keeping them apart: **the logo sits on white or clean neutral space**, and the palette does its work everywhere else — bands, blocks, headline color, rules, buttons, and backgrounds the logo does not occupy.

3. PHOTOS APPEAR IN FULL.

Every photo is shown in its entirety, scaled proportionately. Nothing cropped off, nothing stretched, nothing lost. **If the photo does not fit the space, the space changes — never the photo.** Build the photo's area to the photo's own aspect ratio.

4. ONE PHOTO PER PIECE, CONFINED TO ITS AREA.

Seven photos are supplied per brand (one header, six 2K). Each deliverable is assigned a specific photo in its spec line. No photo repeats while an unused photo remains. A photo is clipped to its region and may never paint outside the box it was given.

5. TYPE GOES ON CLEAN SPACE, NOT ON PHOTOGRAPHS.

Default: type sits beside the image, below it, or on a solid color block from the palette. Where a piece genuinely requires type over image (hero, story, cover), it needs a real legibility treatment — a scrim or strip sized to the text block, not a wash over the whole picture — and must meet 4.5:1 contrast for normal text,

3:1 for large text (18pt, or 14pt bold).

6. THE WORDS FIT THE JOB.

Copy is written for what that specific piece does in the real world, drawn from the brand's own taglines and supplied information. A yard sign says what a yard sign says. A thank-you card says what a thank-you card says. No generic filler repeated across pieces.

7. NOTHING CLIPS. NOTHING IS INVENTED.

All text fits inside its bounds — if it cannot fit at minimum size, the layout is wrong. Fields for the client's own details are labeled plainly ("Your phone," "Your name"). Never fabricate names, phone numbers, addresses, or prices.

8. LOOK BEFORE CALLING IT DONE.

Open every rendered file and look at it with actual eyes. A spec table is not a substitute for looking. No deliverable is declared passing without being seen.

METHOD. Each deliverable's spec line — dimensions, logo concept and placement, assigned photo, type placement, and copy — is written and approved *before* rendering.

PART TWO — WHICH LOGO GOES WHERE

The suite arrives with three concepts. Each has a job. Use the one built for the job; never shrink a logo below its legible size and never modify one to fit.

Concept	Use for
Primary (mark + wordmark)	Large placements: covers, signage, letterhead, cards, presentation covers, avatars with room
Icon (mark, compact)	Small and square: favicons, tight ad boxes, stamps, anywhere the wordmark would fall below legible size
Wordmark (name only)	Wide horizontal spaces: lockups, banner strips, footers

- **Clear space.** Measure from the logo's own height (X). Keep at least 0.4–0.5X of empty margin on every side, free of type, photos, patterns, folds, and page edges.
- **Minimum size.** Every logo has a size below which its details and wordmark stop reading. Below that threshold, switch to the Icon — do not shrink the Primary.
- **Never** stretch, squash, rotate, recolor, add effects to, or place a logo on a busy background.

PART THREE — PER-ITEM SPECIFICATIONS

Universal print standards

- **300 DPI** at final size
- **0.125" bleed** on all four sides
- **Safe area 0.125–0.25"** inside trim — all text and logos live inside it
- CMYK for commercial press; sRGB accepted by online printers
- Headlines and names: at least 4mm from trim, 9–12pt minimum
- Body text: 8–9pt minimum, never below 6pt
- QR codes: 5mm from trim, with a 4-module quiet zone
- Hairline rules: no thinner than 0.25pt

Universal signage law

1 inch of capital letter height = 10 feet of readable distance (United States Sign Council standard). If the sign is read from a moving vehicle: **seven words maximum**, bold sans-serif, high contrast, generous margins.

Item specifications

Item	Specification	Copy	Photo
BUSINESS CARD — 3.5 × 2 in	Trim 1050 × 600 px · Bleed 1125 × 675 px · Safe area 975 × 525 px. Front and back use identical safe-zone insets.	Front: logo, brand name, tagline. Back: contact name, title, phone, email, domain.	None
LETTERHEAD — 8.5 × 11 in	Logo top-left or top-center; contact top-right or in a footer rule; body area left entirely clear for the client's letter.	Identity and contact only.	None
FLYER / PROPERTY SHEET — 8.5 × 11 in	One message, one call to action. Hierarchy through size, weight, spacing and placement together. Related information grouped; short line lengths; nothing in the margins. Detail overflow directs to the website.	Headline · 2–3 sentence description · fact row · contact · CTA.	One, top band, at its own aspect ratio
TRI-FOLD BROCHURE — 11 × 8.5 in, 3 panels	Modular grid; content kept clear of fold lines and trim edges; panels planned in reveal sequence (cover → inside → back).	Cover identity · about panel · offerings panel · contact panel.	Optional, one
THANK-YOU / REFERRAL / GIFT CARDS	Card stock sizes; minimal type; generous margins.	One warm sentence plus a contact line.	None — typographic pieces
YARD SIGN — 24 × 18 in landscape (industry default)	Width allows logo beside name, tagline and phone. 18 × 24 for quiet streets with close setback; 24 × 30 or 24 × 36 for fast roads or deep setbacks. Phone at 3" letter height reads from ~30 ft; scale by the 1" = 10 ft law.	Headline (the offer) · name · phone. Seven words maximum.	None — distance signage is type and logo only
A-FRAME / SIDEWALK SIGN — 24 × 36 in typical	Read at walking or slow-driving pace: 2–3" letters minimum.	What · when · where · who. Short lines.	None
VEHICLE MAGNET	10 × 20 in passenger cars · 12 × 24 in SUVs and pickups · 18 × 24 in and up for vans. Must read from 20–30 ft.	Logo · one line of what the business does · phone.	None
EDDM MAILER — strictest rules in the set	Must exceed 6.125" in height or 10.5" in length (4×6 and 6×9 do not qualify). Maximum 12 × 15 in. Length ÷ height must fall between 1.3 and 2.5 . Address block clear area at least 4" × 1.625". Indicia minimum 0.5" square, ALL CAPS, within 1.625" of the right edge and 1.375" from the top, standing alone. The bottom 2.125" of the address face must be completely clear — USPS barcode zone; any graphic there gets the mailing rejected. Compliant sizes: 6.5 × 9 · 6.25 × 11 · 8.5 × 11 · 9 × 12.	Headline offer · 1–2 supporting lines · contact. Address face stays clean.	One, front face only

Item	Specification	Copy	Photo
SOCIAL — FEED POST — 1080 × 1350 (4:5)	Portrait is the 2026 native format; it occupies more screen than square.	Hook line · 1–2 supporting lines · CTA.	One, own band, true ratio
SOCIAL — STORY — 1080 × 1920 (9:16)	Top 250 px and bottom 340 px must stay free of text and logos — platform UI covers them. All content lives in the central band.	Short. Three lines maximum.	One, central band
SOCIAL — COVER PHOTO	Facebook cover 851 × 315 · X header 1500 × 500. Crops differently on desktop and mobile: design center-weighted, treat far edges as expendable.	Brand name · tagline · domain.	One, or clean color field
SOCIAL — PROFILE PICTURE	Upload 720 × 720 or larger (Facebook minimum display 180 × 180). Displays as a circle — keep the mark centered with generous margin.	None — logo only.	None
SHARE / OG IMAGE — 1200 × 630 (1.91:1)	The link-preview card for Facebook, LinkedIn, X, iMessage and Slack.	Brand name · tagline · domain.	Optional
YOUTUBE CHANNEL ART — 2560 × 1440	All content must sit inside the central 1546 × 423 safe area — everything outside is cropped on phones and TVs.	Brand name · tagline.	Optional background
FAVICON — 16 / 32 / 48 / 180 px	Use the delivered favicons if the art department supplied them. If generating: use the Icon concept, contained, never the Primary.	None.	None
EMAIL SIGNATURE	300–400 px wide · 150–200 px tall. Images under 100 KB each. Logo displayed at 150–300 px width, saved at 2× resolution. Maximum 2 columns (3 absolute limit).	Name · title · company · phone · email · domain.	None

PART FOUR — WHAT WENT WRONG BEFORE

Recorded from the July 23–24, 2026 session. Every item below was a real failure found by the Founder in delivered client files.

Failure	Cause	Rule
Logos fuzzy — "used to look beautiful"	Background removal plus a six-step downscale applied to finished art	1
Favicon rebuilt worse than the delivered one	Spec said "favicons from vector" — regenerating what already existed	1
Wrong colors (navy/gold instead of the card palette)	Colors sampled off a logo image instead of read from the brand card	2
Agent's head cut off in a cover	Center-crop of a wide photo into a narrow band	3
Photo painted across the copy area	Photo scaled to cover but never clipped to its region	4
Type unreadable over a photo	Text placed on a busy image with no legibility treatment	5
Same photo on eleven pieces	No photo assigned per deliverable	4
Identical text across different pieces	Copy not written for each piece's job	6
Broken files declared "PASS"	Code gates run; files never opened and looked at	8

The structural lesson. Every one of these was "fixed" at the time by adding a new processing step — trace it, plate it, step it, sample it. Each addition created the next failure. **The correction is subtraction.** The art arrives finished. Place it.

PART FIVE — DEFERRED (DO NOT IMPROVISE)

These are real needs that do not have researched answers yet. Do not invent rules for them. Ask the Founder.

- **Occasion and holiday variants** — a client's Easter, Christmas, or grand-opening piece may leave the brand palette. Triggered by the client's request or the occasion, never by Claude's taste. Rules to be written when studied.
- **Client customization fields** — the industry pattern is a governed template: brand elements locked, named zones left editable. To be specified later.
- **Additional photo calls** — permitted for special occasions the seven supplied photos cannot serve. Not for basics.

Sources. Specifications in Part Three are drawn from published industry standards: United States Sign Council letter-height guidance; USPS Domestic Mail Manual 207.24 (EDDM); WCAG 2.1 contrast criteria;

platform-published 2026 social dimensions; standard commercial print bleed and safe-area practice; and brand-guideline conventions for logo clear space and minimum size.